

Derivation for time period of simple pendulum using Dimensional Analysis:

There are three factors on which the time period of a simple pendulum depends:-

mass of the bob = m

Length of the string = L

acceleration due to gravity = g

Hence,

$$T \propto m^a L^b g^c \rightarrow (i)$$

$$[T] \propto [M]^a [L]^b [LT^{-2}]^c$$

$$[T] \propto [M]^a [L]^b [L]^c [T]^{-2c}$$

$$[T] \propto [M]^a [L]^{b+c} [T]^{-2c}$$

equating powers we get

$$1 = -2c \quad ; \quad 0 = b + c \quad ; \quad a = 0$$

$$c = -\frac{1}{2} \quad ; \quad 0 = b - \frac{1}{2} \quad ;$$

$$; \quad b = \frac{1}{2}$$

putting values in eq (i)

$$T \propto m^0 L^{1/2} g^{-1/2}$$

$$T \propto \left(\frac{L}{g} \right)^{1/2}$$

$$T \propto \sqrt{\frac{L}{g}} \Rightarrow T = K \sqrt{\frac{L}{g}}$$

where K is proportionality constant
and its value is 2π

$$T = 2\pi \sqrt{\frac{L}{g}}$$